

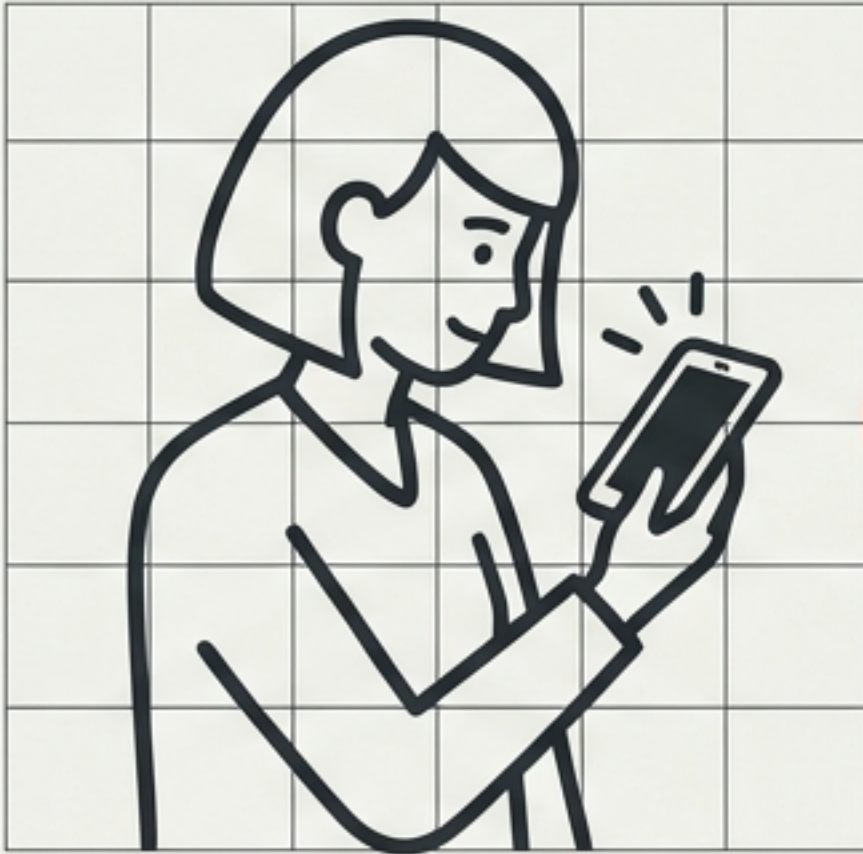
API for Business Analysts: Everything You Need to Know

From technical jargon to business value. The
Translator's Handbook for defining software rules.



 Save for Later

The Concept: You Don't Go Into the Kitchen



The Client (Customer)

Hungry for data. "Show me restaurants near 500016".



The API (Waiter)

The Messenger. Takes the request to the kitchen and brings the response back.

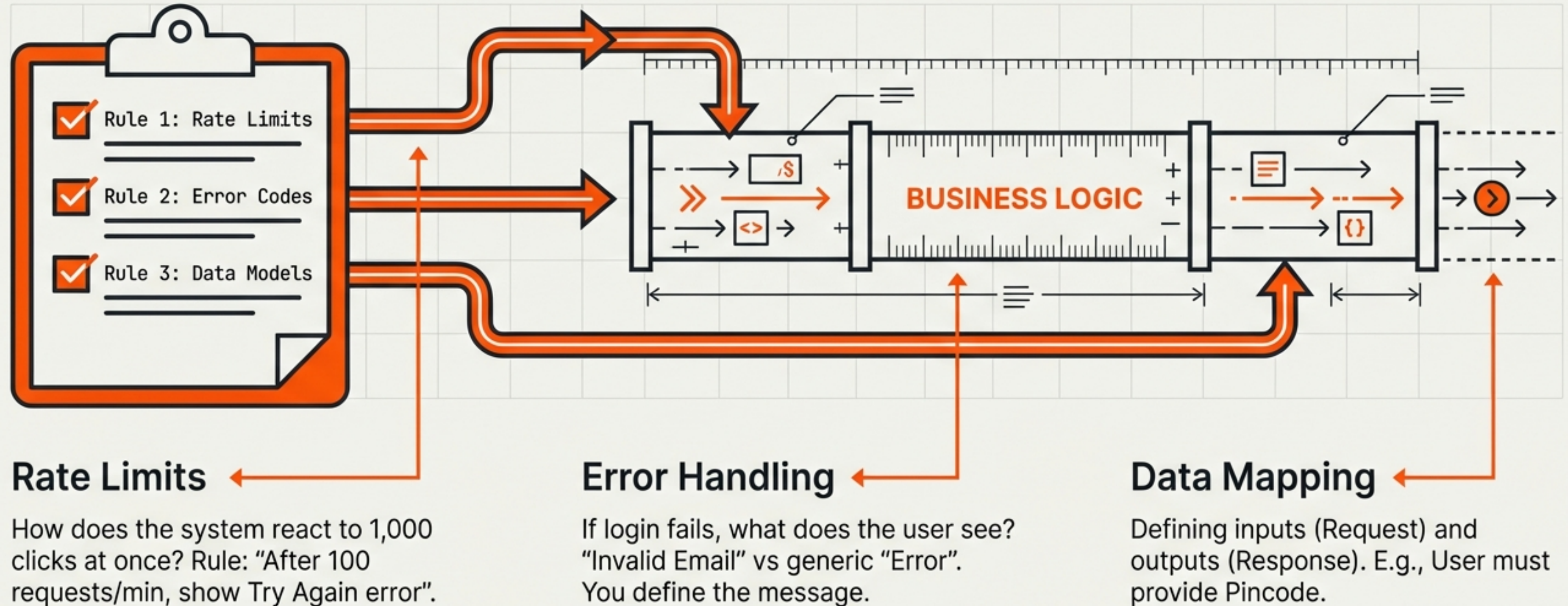


The Server (Kitchen)

Where raw data ingredients are processed.

Insight: An API is a contract that lets two systems talk without knowing each other's secrets.

You Don't Code the API. You Define the Rules.



"Developers build the pipe. BAs decide what flows through it."

The 4 Types of APIs (And When to Use Them)



REST (The Toyota Camry)

Standard. Universal.
Lightweight JSON. Used by
Netflix, Zomato.



SOAP (The Fortress)

Strict. Heavy XML. High Security.
Used by Banks & Government.



GraphQL (The Precision Tool)

Flexible. Prevents over-fetching.
"Ask for name, get only name."
Used by Instagram.



Webhooks (The Doorbell)

Event-driven. "Don't call us, we'll
call you." Used for Order Status
updates.

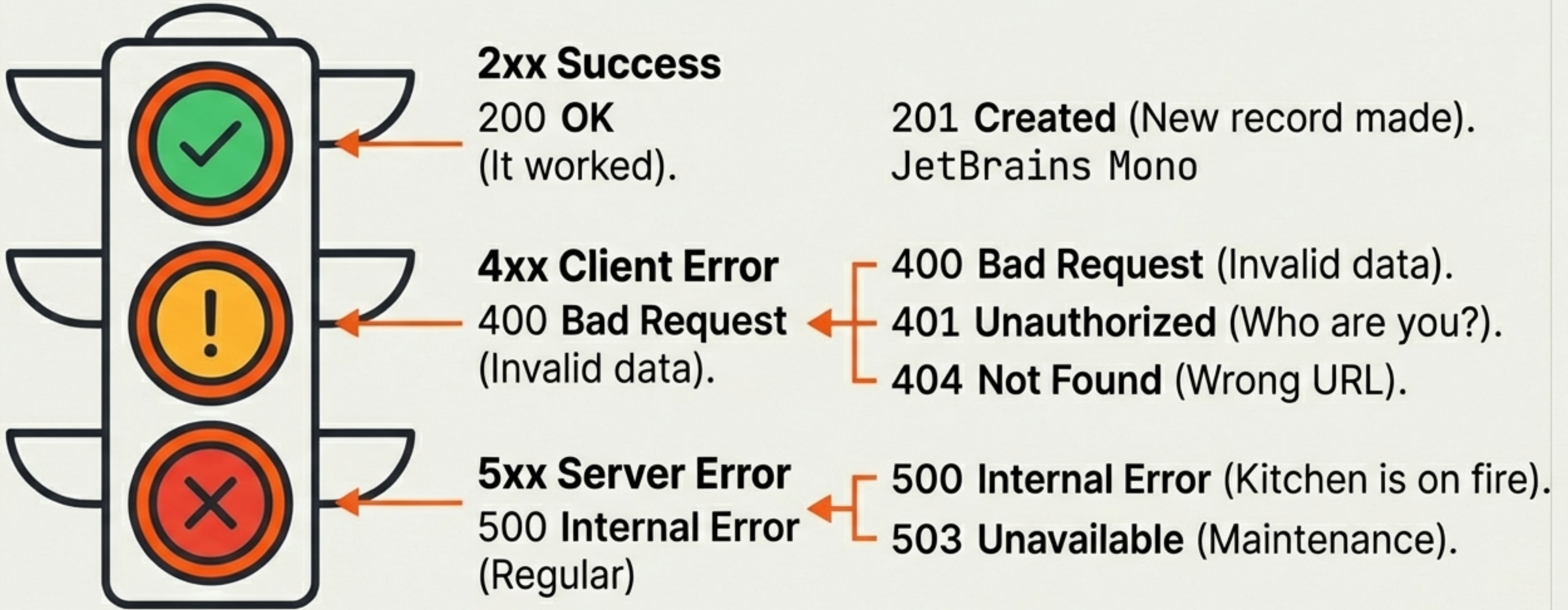
Insight: Choosing the right API type is crucial for performance, security, and developer experience. No single API fits all needs.

The Actions: HTTP Methods & CRUD

	GET (Read)	Retrieve data. Safe & Cacheable. (e.g., View Menu)
	POST (Create)	Send new data. Changes server state. (e.g., Place Order)
	PUT (Update)	Replace entire entry. (e.g., Change whole order)
	PATCH (Update)	Update partial data. (e.g., Change just the drink)
	DELETE	Remove data. (e.g., Delete Account)

Pro Tip: GET is safe. POST changes the server—never cache a money transfer!

Status Codes: What Did the Server Say?



Status codes are the server's way of giving feedback without words.

Security: AuthN vs. AuthZ

Authentication (AuthN)



Who are you?

Verifying identity (Login/Password).

Showing ID at the building entrance.

Authorization (AuthZ)



What are you allowed to do?

Permissions / Access Levels.

Your ID opens the Lobby,
but NOT the Server Room.

A Student logs in (AuthN) but is denied access to the Admin Exam Panel (AuthZ).

The Language: JSON vs XML

JSON (Lightweight)

```
{  
  "name": "John",  
  "role": "BA"  
}
```

Used in REST APIs. Minimal.
Fast for mobile networks.

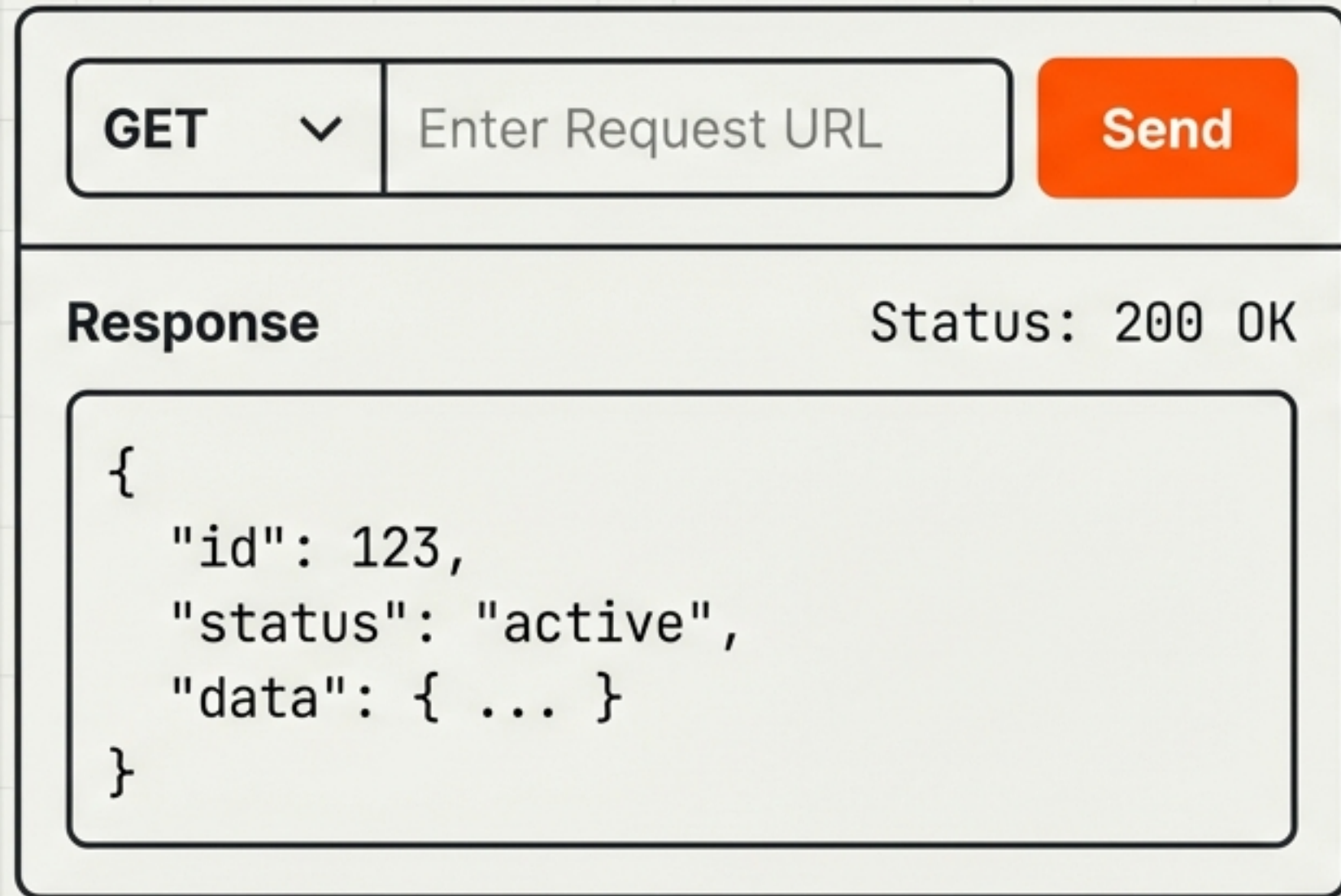
XML (Heavy)

```
<user>  
  <name>John</name>  
  <role>BA</role>  
</user>
```

Used in SOAP. Structured.
Verbose and heavy.

JSON creates less data traffic than XML,
making it the **standard for modern apps**.

Postman: The BA's Testing Ground



A mockup of the Postman API client interface. At the top, there is a dropdown menu set to 'GET' with a downward arrow, followed by a text input field containing 'Enter Request URL', and an orange 'Send' button. Below this, the 'Response' tab is selected, showing a status of '200 OK'. The response body is a JSON object displayed in a light gray box with rounded corners.

```
{
  "id": 123,
  "status": "active",
  "data": { ... }
}
```

Why wait for the UI? Test business rules directly.

1. Enter Endpoint (from API Docs).
2. Select Method (GET/POST).
3. Click Send.
4. Verify Status Code and Response.

The BA's API Cheat Sheet

Analogy	API = Waiter. Documentation = Menu.
Methods	GET (Read), POST (Create), PUT (Update), DELETE (Remove).
Codes	200 (OK), 400 (Bad Request), 401 (Unauthorized), 404 (Not Found), 500 (Server Error).
Types	REST (Standard), SOAP (Secure), GraphQL (Precise), Webhooks (Event).
BA Role	Define Rate Limits, Error Messages, and Data Inputs.

APIs are the backbone of software. As a BA, you define the spine.